

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

# REALTOR.COM'S CEO JUST CALLED OUT PRIVATE LISTINGS.

---

Damian Eales said agents pushing them are on the wrong side of history. He's right, and one word gives away his real motive.

**D.J. Paris**  
Keeping It Real Podcast

**kale**  
Realty

learn more at [joinkale.com](https://joinkale.com)

“

**CHOICE ONLY  
COUNTS WHEN THE  
SELLER KNOWS  
THE COST.**

That's the tell in the private-listing pitch every agent needs to hear.



# HIS NAME IS DAMIAN EALES, CEO OF REALTOR.COM.

This week he drew a line. A home is most of a family's wealth, and hiding it from the market for a quiet deal isn't serving that family. It's the agent putting commission ahead of the client's price.

# "YEARS FROM NOW, YOU'RE ON THE RIGHT SIDE OF THIS OR THE WRONG ONE."

Eales calls it a right side of history test.



# EALES RUNS A LISTING SITE.

Open listings are his business model. He benefits from saying this out loud.

# THE TELL ISN'T HIS MOTIVE. IT'S THE PITCH.

Agents call it "seller choice." But choice only counts when the seller knows the cost: fewer buyers, fewer offers, almost always a lower number.

# WHAT TO DO AT YOUR NEXT LISTING APPOINTMENT:

- 1** Stop offering private as an equal option.
- 2** Lead with full exposure as your recommendation.
- 3** If they still want quiet, put it in writing that you advised against it.



## THE TAKEAWAY

**PULL YOUR LAST  
PRIVATE-LISTING  
CONVERSATION.  
DID YOU LEAD  
WITH EXPOSURE,  
OR DID YOU OFFER  
IT AS A NEUTRAL  
MENU ITEM?**

Years from now, your file shows which side you were on.